THE LITTLEST SISTER, WHEN SHE BLACKS OUT

THE KARIN SERIES

THE COMPLETE SERIES — EPISODES 1–8

Movements I · II · III

Manga in Da Vinci pencil — Japanese first, English beneath.

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Johnathan 'Qasparr' Monroe, ARR

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MOVEMENT I — THE INTAKE

EPISODE 1

THE INTAKE

（受付）

Episode 1 — The Intake

Episode 1 — The Blackout

Episode 1 — The Office

THE LITTLEST SISTER, WHEN SHE BLACKS OUT
Manga Arc — Episode 1: THE INTAKE （受付）

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———

PANEL 1 — Wide. Karakura Town at night. The Kurosaki clinic, one lit window. The sky: cloud-choked, starless, MOONLESS.
CAPTION:
月無き夜、空座町。
[A moonless night. Karakura Town.]
CAPTION:
戦ひは終はりて、十二年。
[Twelve years since the war ended.]

PANEL 2 — The clinic step. KARIN, 25, clinic coat over her shoulders, breath smoking. Across the step, a seated SOUL in a torn captain's haori stares at nothing.
KARIN:
…見えるよ、あんた。
[...I can see you. You know that.]

PANEL 3 — Close on the soul's wrists: CHAINS, link upon link, every link pressed with a paper stamp-tag.
CAPTION:
鎖。判子だらけの、鎖。
[Chains. Chains covered in stamps.]

PANEL 4 —
CAPTAIN:
醫者か。
[Are you the doctor?]
KARIN:
娘だ。名前は。
[The daughter. Your name.]

PANEL 5 — The captain looks at his own stamped wrists.
CAPTAIN:
名は——事務廳が上書きした。
[My name — the Office wrote over it.]

PANEL 6 — Behind him, light folds open like a blind: a DESK in the dark, registers stacked to the ceiling, a CLERK seated, stamp raised. The intake office of Hell.
CLERK (katakana officialese):
書類ニ不備ナシ。聴聞ハ不要デアル。
[THE PAPERS ARE WITHOUT DEFECT. A HEARING IS UNNECESSARY.]

PANEL 7 — Karin. The flat stare. Frost runs off the step's edge. Every small sound in the street goes out like a lamp.
KARIN:
…寒いな。
[...Cold, isn't it.]

PANEL 8 — BLACKOUT. Her eyes white over entirely. At her jaw, the SHADOW OF A MASK, half-formed. Her hand closes on the chain.
SFX: ドクン [dokun — one heartbeat, too loud]
KARIN (white-eyed, quiet):
この鎖、全部讀める。
[I can read every link of this chain.]

PANEL 9 — She leans close to the captain, and SPEAKS — the panel withholds the word itself; only his face answers, wrecked with relief.
KARIN:
あんたの本當の名は——
[Your true name is—]

PANEL 10 — The clerk's stamp, frozen mid-air. For the first time, the office looks up.
CLERK:
其ノ名ハ、登録ヨリ抹消濟デアル。
[THAT NAME HAS ALREADY BEEN STRUCK FROM THE REGISTER.]
CAPTION:
惡魔の舞は、まだ始まらぬ。
[The Devil's Dance has not yet begun.]

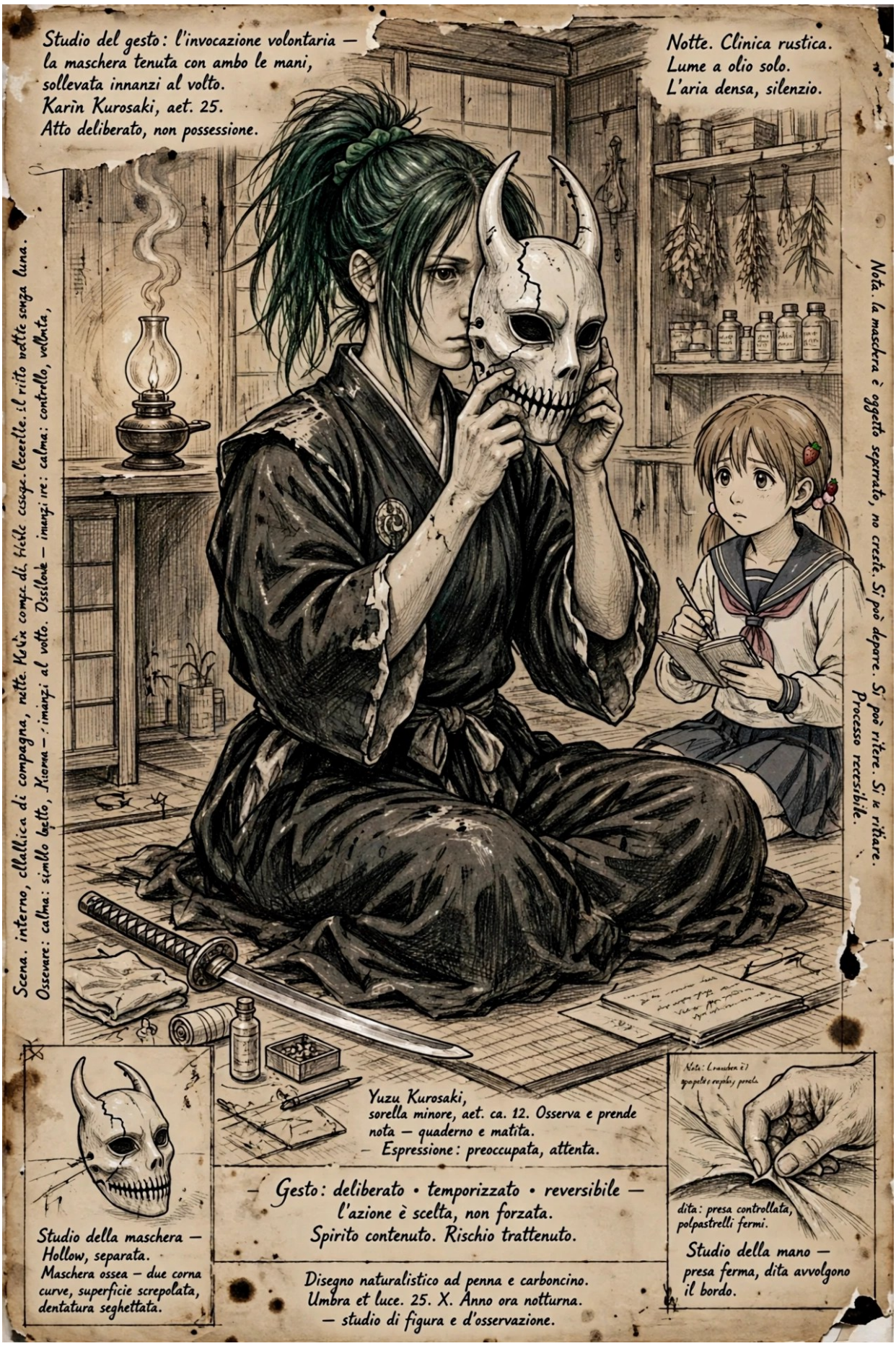
———
Episode 1 ends. The founder's rulings seated in this script: Karin leads; the blackout is Hollowfication arriving uninvited; her Bankai is INHERITED, and its release — the female version of AKUMA NO MAI MUGETSU — is reserved to Movement III, the Moonless Hearing. Her sword: MVRRAMASSA. Her mask's face: still his pen.

EPISODE 2

THE SECOND STAMP

（二度判）

Episode 2 — The Delivery



Episode 2 — The Invocation

Episode 2 — The Register

THE LITTLEST SISTER, WHEN SHE BLACKS OUT
Manga Arc — Episode 2: THE SECOND STAMP （二度判）

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PANELS ILLUSTRATED (Da Vinci pencil-sketch plates):
Panel 2 -> panel-04-the-delivery.webp
Panel 7 -> panel-05-the-invocation.webp
Panel 10 -> panel-06-the-register.webp

———

PANEL 1 — Wide. The clinic step, the next night. The sky again cloud-choked and MOONLESS. Two junior CLERKS of the office, faces lost under their caps, set a seated SOUL down on the step like a delivered parcel, bow to the empty air, and are gone between one breath and the next.
CAPTION:
翌夜。また、月無シ。
[The next night. Again, no moon.]
CAPTION:
荷物ノ如ク、魂一ツ届ク。
[Like a parcel, one soul is delivered.]

PANEL 2 — The soul: an elderly STATIONMASTER, cap straight, hands folded on his knees with terrible politeness. His chains are neat, almost tidy — and every paper tag on them is stamped TWICE, the second stamp laid over the first.
CAPTION:
判ハ、二度押サレテヰタ。
[The stamps had been pressed twice.]

PANEL 3 — KARIN crouched at his feet, running the chain through her fingers BACKWARD, link by link, from the death outward.
KARIN:
…新しい判が、古い判の上に。
[…The newer stamp sits on top of the old one.]

PANEL 4 — Close on two tags side by side. The first stamp carries the day of his death. The second certifies a hearing — and is dated AFTER it.
KARIN:

死ンダ日ヨリ、後ノ日附ダ。
[It's dated after the day he died.]
CAPTION:
聴聞ハ無カッタ。判ダケガ、後カラ来タノデアル。
[There was no hearing. Only the stamp came, afterward.]

PANEL 5 — The stationmaster has not moved. His politeness is a man still standing on a platform, waiting to be called.
STATIONMASTER:
儂ハ待ッタノダ。呼バレルノヲ、ズット待ッタ。
[I waited. I waited and waited to be called.]

PANEL 6 — Inside the clinic. YUZU at the table with a notebook, marking a tally by lamplight. The lamp burns a finger's width lower than the night before.
YUZU:
二度目。…明リガ、少シ落チタ。
[Second time. ...The light's dropped a little.]

PANEL 7 — KARIN seated on the floor, worn shihakushou, the MASK across her knees — bone-white, horned, cracked, whole. THE sketch's mask. She lifts it with both hands, deliberate, eyes open. This is not the blackout. This is the INVOCATION.
KARIN:
時間ハ三分。過ギタラ、外セ。
[Three minutes. If I go past it, take it off me.]
CAPTION:
今度ハ、自分デ被ルノデアル。
[This time, she puts it on herself.]

PANEL 8 — Masked. Her posture does not change; her voice does not change. Reading the chain's memory: a registrar's hand, brush and stamp — and in the stroke, a hesitation.
KARIN (masked, steady):
押シタ手ガ、迷ッテヰル。…知ッテヰタンダナ、アンタモ。
[The hand that stamped it hesitated. ...You knew, too. Didn't you.]

PANEL 9 — She takes the mask off herself, inside the three minutes. Her own face, tired, unimpressed. Behind her, Yuzu stares at the lamp: the flame stands exactly where it stood.
YUZU:
…明リ、落チテナイ。
[...The light didn't drop.]
KARIN:
だろ。
[Told you.]

PANEL 10 — The intake office of Hell. Registers to the ceiling. The CLERK turns a great ledger to a page that has never existed before, and writes a new heading with great care.
CLERK (katakana officialese):
新規登録。項目——「讀者、未届」。
[NEW REGISTER ENTRY. ITEM: "READER, UNFILED."]
CAPTION:
事務廳ニハ彼女ノ用紙ガ無カッタ。故ニ、用紙ガ作ラレタノデアル。

[The Office had no form for her. And so a form was made.]

———

Episode 2 ends. The founder's rulings seated in this script: the bloodline is the KUROSAKI bloodline; her power is NATURAL, never transferred, and the office holds no form for her — so it makes one. The mask is the Leonardo sheet's mask, taken up by her own hand: the first INVOCATION, timed and set down again, against the blackout that takes her. Yuzu keeps the count of the light. The dance is not begun; it is reserved to Movement III, the Moonless Hearing. Her sword: MVRRAMASSA.

MOVEMENT II — THE HEARINGS THAT NEVER HAPPENED

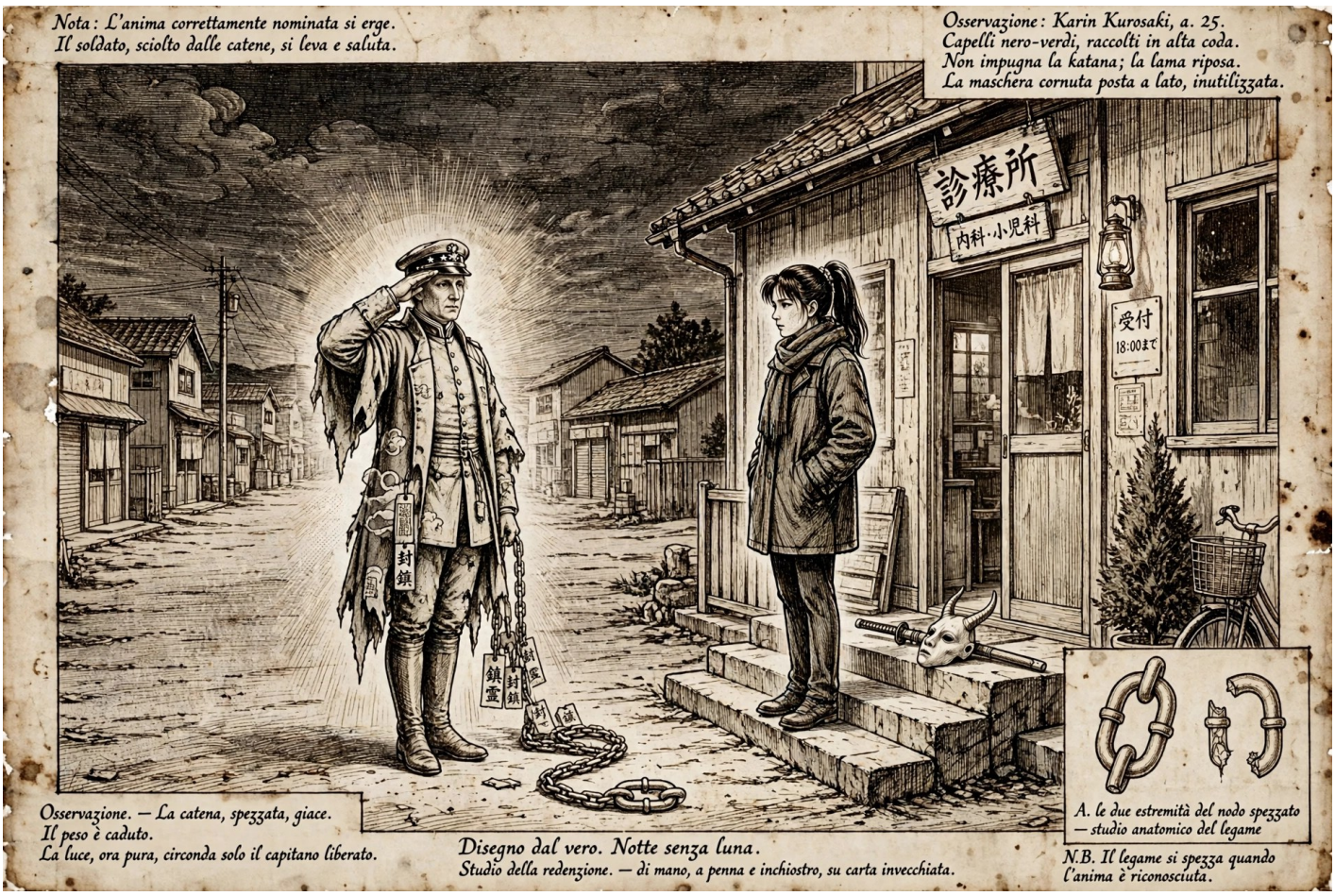
EPISODE 3

THE TRUE NAME

（本當ノ名）

Episode 3 — The Writing Desk

Episode 3 — The True Name



Episode 3 — The Release

THE LITTLEST SISTER, WHEN SHE BLACKS OUT
Manga Arc — Episode 3: THE TRUE NAME （本當ノ名）

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MOVEMENT II — THE HEARINGS THAT NEVER HAPPENED begins.

PANELS ILLUSTRATED (Da Vinci pencil-sketch plates):
Panel 4 -> panel-07-the-writing-desk.webp
Panel 8 -> panel-08-the-true-name.webp
Panel 9 -> panel-09-the-release.webp

———

PANEL 1 — The clinic step, moonless dark. The CAPTAIN of the first night waits where she left him. KARIN kneels and takes up his chain — not to read it forward this time. Backward.
CAPTION:
鎖ヲ、逆ニ辿ルノデアル。
[She walks the chain backward.]

PANEL 2 — The chain's memory, younger light: a young officer at a ship's desk, writing his own name into a roster with a steady hand, proud of the strokes.
CAPTION:
名ガ、本人ノ手デ書カレタ日。
[The day the name was written by its owner's own hand.]

PANEL 3 — Deeper. The office, years past. A sealed directive comes down from above — no face, only a cord and a seal. The REGISTRAR receives it with both hands and bows to it.
REGISTRAR (katakana officialese):
書キ換ヘヨ、トノ御指示デアル。
[THE INSTRUCTION IS THAT IT BE OVERWRITTEN.]

PANEL 4 — Close on the registrar's desk. The brush blacks out the name, stroke by stroke. Above the ruin, a number is written in its place. But ink is only ink: beneath it, the old strokes stand in the paper's grain.
CAPTION:
墨ノ下ニ、名ハ殘ッテヰタノデアル。
[Under the ink, the name had remained.]

PANEL 5 — The clinic step, the present. Karin opens her eyes. Not white. Hers. The mask hangs untouched at her side — the discipline held: invocation, not blackout.
KARIN:
…分カッタ。
[…Got it.]

PANEL 6 — She stands before the captain. For once there is no flatness in her voice. It is almost a roll-call.
KARIN:
立チナ。最後ニ、呼ンデヤル。
[Stand up. I'll call you properly — one last time.]

PANEL 7 — The captain rises. His chains pull taut and sing. In the dark beyond the step the light folds open: the office is watching, a row of silhouette clerks, the stamp lowered and forgotten in a raised hand.

PANEL 8 — KARIN speaks the TRUE NAME. Full voice, the way a name is called across water.
KARIN:
磯部源次郎。
[ISOBE GENJIROU.]
SFX: パリン
[parin — one link, snapping like glass]

PANEL 9 — ONE LINK — the first link, the name-link — hangs broken. The whole chain slackens in his hands. The captain stands straighter than death left him; something young crosses his face. He salutes HER. Not the office. Her.
CAPTAIN:
…有難ウ。醫者ノ娘サン。
[…Thank you. Doctor's daughter.]
CAPTION:
名ヲ正シク呼バレタ魂ハ、立ツノデアル。
[A soul called by its right name stands up.]

PANEL 10 — The intake office. The CLERK stares into the great register, where one ruled line has gone quietly blank, the ink lifted out of it like breath off glass.
CLERK (katakana officialese, shaken):
登録ガ…一ツ、消エタ。
[A REGISTER ENTRY HAS… VANISHED.]
CAPTION:
事務廳ハ、初メテ損ヲ出シタノデアル。
[For the first time, the Office showed a loss.]

———
Episode 3 ends. The founder's rulings seated in this script: Movement I is closed; the hearings that never happened are now walked backward, chain by chain. The discipline holds — invocation, never blackout; the mask is carried, not needed. A soul is released the office's own way, in reverse: by being correctly named. The captain's true name is desk-given in this

draft (Isobe Genjirou), the founder's pen over it. The dance is not begun; it is reserved to Movement III, the Moonless Hearing. Her sword: MVRRAMASSA.

EPISODE 4

THE AUDITOR

（監査官）

Episode 4 — The Auditor

Episode 4 — The Form

Episode 4 — The Answer

THE LITTLEST SISTER, WHEN SHE BLACKS OUT
Manga Arc — Episode 4: THE AUDITOR （監査官）

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MOVEMENT II — THE HEARINGS THAT NEVER HAPPENED, continued. The Auditor is not counsel. The Hearing is Movement III, later.

PANELS ILLUSTRATED (Da Vinci pencil-sketch plates):
Panel 5 -> panel-10-the-auditor.webp
Panel 9 -> panel-11-the-form.webp
Panel 10 -> panel-12-the-answer.webp

———

PANEL 1 — The clinic step, worn smooth by nights. Captions only, over the empty street: the deliveries, the readings, the one release, all behind us now.
CAPTION:
七夜、續イタノデアル。
[Seven nights, running.]

PANEL 2 — Inside. YUZU's notebook open on the table: page after page of small, even tally marks. Her pencil is down to a stub. The row of lamp-oil bottles by the wall stands emptier by one each time the eye crosses the page.
CAPTION:
數ハ、姉妹ノ片方ガ付ケテヰル。
[The count is kept by one of the sisters.]

PANEL 3 — Yuzu counts under her breath, and stops at the same place twice.
YUZU:
十。…カリン、十ニナッタ。
[Ten. ...Karin, it's reached ten.]
KARIN:
數エルナ、ユズ。
[Stop counting, Yuzu.]
YUZU:
誰カガ數エナイト、誰モ止マラナイ。
[If nobody counts, nobody stops.]

PANEL 4 — Over the whole town, a sound like one enormous page turning. In the street below, the shadows straighten themselves into columns. Something is coming down the road that has never needed the road before.
CAPTION:
監査官ガ、降リテ來ルノデアル。
[The Auditor is coming down.]

PANEL 5 — THE AUDITOR on the clinic step. Tall, in layered court robes older than the office itself, a long ledger-case under one arm and an abacus of black beads at his belt. His face is calm, and terribly polite. Behind him the clerks stand in two rows like a choir that has forgotten the song. He bows — precisely, not deeply.
AUDITOR (katakana officialese):
監査デアル。協力ヲ乞ウ。
[THIS IS AN AUDIT. YOUR COOPERATION IS REQUESTED.]

PANEL 6 — He unrolls a scroll at arm's length and reads the office's own losses back to the street, item by item, without heat.
AUDITOR:
損失、一。疑義、三。…讀者、一。
[LOSSES: ONE. QUERIES: THREE. …READERS: ONE.]

PANEL 7 — KARIN steps down off the step. The mask is in her hand at her side — carried, not worn. She does not reach for anything.
KARIN:
讀者ハ私ダ。
[The reader is me.]
AUDITOR:
分カッテヰル。
[WE KNOW.]

PANEL 8 — From the ledger-case the Auditor draws a single sheet — new paper, ink still dark on it — and offers it with both hands, the way one offers a verdict.
AUDITOR:
貴女ノ用紙ヲ、用意シタ。出頭ヲ、命ズル。
[WE HAVE PREPARED YOUR FORM. YOU ARE SUMMONED TO APPEAR.]

PANEL 9 — Close on the sheet in Karin's hands. Two ruled fields at its head, both empty, waiting like open graves:
NAME — (blank). LINEAGE — (blank).
KARIN (quiet):
…名前ト、血統。
[…Name. And bloodline.]
CAPTION:
彼女ヲ屈ケサセレバ、事務廳ノ勝チデアル。
[If they can get her filed, the Office wins.]

PANEL 10 — Karin looks up from the sheet. The flat stare — and under it, just barely, the grin the whole street learned young. The scary one, deciding.

KARIN:
届ケハ出サナイ。…デモ、行ッテヤル。聴聞トヤラヲ、見セテモラオウ。
[I won't file. …But I'll come. Let's see this "hearing" of yours.]
CAPTION:
悪魔の舞は、まだ始まらぬ。だが、招待ハ届イタノデアル。
[The Devil's Dance has not yet begun. But the invitation has arrived.]

———
Episode 4 ends — on a cliff's edge, by design. The founder's rulings seated in this script: the Auditor is an auditor, not counsel — Movement III's Hearing is NOT entered; the dance is not begun, only invited. The office's victory condition is paperwork: a name and a bloodline in two blank fields. The bloodline they would write down is the KUROSAKI bloodline, and she will not write it for them. Yuzu's count reaches ten — the number is desk-set in this draft, the founder's pen over it; what the count reaches before she says stop remains his open seam. Her sword: MVRRAMASSA. Her mask: the Leonardo sheet's mask, carried in her hand.

EPISODE 5

THE REGISTRAR'S HAND

（書記ノ手）

Episode 5 — The Empty Hearing

Episode 5 — The Hesitation

Episode 5 — The Registrar's Chain

THE LITTLEST SISTER, WHEN SHE BLACKS OUT
Manga Arc — Episode 5: THE REGISTRAR'S HAND （書記ノ手）

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MOVEMENT II — THE HEARINGS THAT NEVER HAPPENED, continued.
Built after Episodes 2–4 stood complete; the Hearing is not entered. The dance is not begun.

PANELS ILLUSTRATED (Da Vinci pencil-sketch plates):
Panel 4 -> panel-13-the-empty-hearing.webp
Panel 5 -> panel-14-the-hesitation.webp
Panel 8 -> panel-15-the-registrars-chain.webp

———

PANEL 1 — The clinic step. The STATIONMASTER still sits in his terrible politeness, cap straight, waiting to be called by a hearing that never sat. KARIN takes up his double-stamped chain a second time.
KARIN:
今度ハ、押シタ手ヲ読ム。
[This time I read the hand that stamped it.]

PANEL 2 — Backward along the chain: the office's delivery room, souls shelved like parcels awaiting collection, each with its tags. No faces. Only handwriting.
CAPTION:
鎖ノ記憶ハ、手書キデ出來テヰル。
[A chain's memory is made of handwriting.]

PANEL 3 — The night of the second stamp. A hearing room inside the office: a long table, a bell, rows of chairs — every chair empty. The hour for the hearing comes, and goes, in silence.
CAPTION:
聽聞ノ時刻ハ、來テ、過ギタノデアル。
[The hour of the hearing came, and passed.]

PANEL 4 — The REGISTRAR alone at the desk at the room's end, the stationmaster's tag before him, the great stamp raised. One lamp. All those empty chairs behind the stamp's shadow. His orders say the hearing was held. The chairs say otherwise.

PANEL 5 — Close: the registrar's hand. It trembles — once, slightly. The stamp comes down anyway. But a fraction off, a hair to the left: the overlap on every tag is the fossil of that tremor.
CAPTION:
迷ヒハ、化石ニナッテ殘ル。
[Hesitation remains, as a fossil.]

PANEL 6 — Deeper along the memory: the registrar's desk, and on it the two papers of his life. A directive from above, cord and seal. And beside it, half-hidden under the blotter — his OWN file. From his own sleeve, where no one looks, the first bright links of a chain are forming.
CAPTION:
押ス者モ、屆出濟ミデアル。
[The one who stamps is also filed.]

PANEL 7 — The clinic step, the present. Karin opens her eyes. Hers. The mask untouched at her side; she has read by invocation, and what she read was a man's hand, shaking.
KARIN:
…アンタモ、判待チカ。
[…You're waiting on a stamp too.]

PANEL 8 — The intake office, now. The REGISTRAR at his desk among the registers, stamping steadily, competently — and from beneath his sleeve, trailing where his own eye never falls, one single chain link, and on it a tag that is BLANK. Unstamped. Unread. His.

PANEL 9 — The clinic step. Karin lowers the stationmaster's chain, gently, the way one sets down a sleeping thing. She looks toward the dark where the office folds open — and closes her hand, and does not reach.
KARIN:
今夜ハ、読マナイ。
[Tonight, I don't read you.]

PANEL 10 — A high annex of the office. A clerk delivers a report; the AUDITOR reads it standing, the black beads of his abacus perfectly still for the first time.
AUDITOR (katakana officialese, quietly):
讀マナカッタ、ト。
[SHE DID NOT READ HIM.]
CAPTION:
彼女ノ遠慮ガ、事務廳ヲ一番怖レサセタノデアル。
[Her restraint frightened the Office most of all.]

———
Episode 5 ends. The founder's rulings seated in this script: Movement II continues — the records walked backward now reach the office's own people: the hand that stamps is itself filed, and its hesitation is preserved in every double stamp as a fossil. The discipline holds and deepens: invocation, never

blackout — and now restraint, the reading deliberately NOT done. The Hearing is not entered; the dance is not begun; both are reserved to Movement III. Her sword: MVRRAMASSA. Her mask: the Leonardo sheet's mask, carried and unneeded.

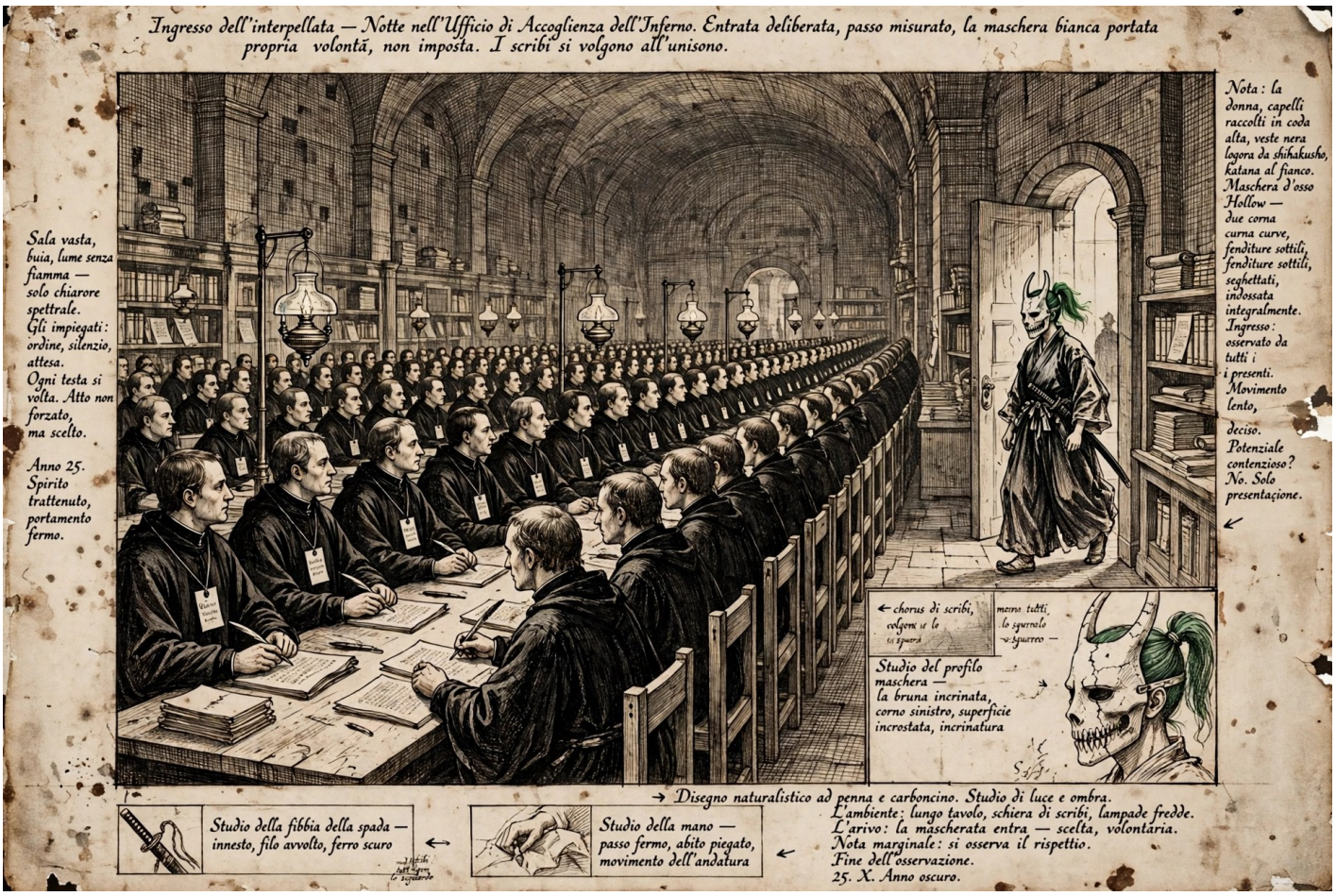
MOVEMENT III — THE MOONLESS HEARING

EPISODE 6

THE COUNSEL

（代言人）

Episode 6 — The Descent



Episode 6 — The Masked Entry

Episode 6 — The Opening

THE LITTLEST SISTER, WHEN SHE BLACKS OUT
Manga Arc — Episode 6: THE COUNSEL （代言人）

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directly beneath. The Japanese is set in the FIRST EMPIRE'S
DIALECT [desk reading, declared]: imperial-era register —
kyuujitai character forms, historical kana, the de-aru voice for
narration, katakana officialese for Hell's office, and Karin's
own blunt plain speech left plain. MVRRAMASSA and the dance are
the founder's; the dance's full form is spent HERE, in the
hearing, as he reserved it.

MOVEMENT III — THE MOONLESS HEARING. The office, frightened by
a restraint it could not file, appeals upward. What comes down
is not another auditor. It is counsel.

PANELS ILLUSTRATED (Da Vinci pencil-sketch plates):
Panel 2 -> panel-16-the-descent.webp
Panel 5 -> panel-17-the-masked-entry.webp
Panel 9 -> panel-18-the-opening.webp

———

PANEL 1 — A high annex of the office, higher than any shown
before. The AUDITOR's report — a scroll bound in black cord —
is taken UP, hand to hand, along a stair of clerks kneeling in
the dark, each bowing as it passes.
CAPTION:
上訴ハ、受理サレタノデアル。
[The appeal was accepted.]

PANEL 2 — The stair's top. A door that is only a frame of dark,
and through it, descending unhurriedly, THE COUNSEL: tall, in
robes cut like a judge's and worn like mourning, a face like a
man who has read every file ever written. Under one arm, bound
in cord, a case-file THICK AS A DOOR — the brother's file.
CAPTION:
地獄ハ、代言人ヲ降ロシタ。
[Hell sent down its Counsel.]

PANEL 3 — A clerk kneels with the docket. The Counsel does not
sit. He asks the respondent's name as one asks the hour.
COUNSEL (katakana officialese, courteous):
被告ハ、黒崎一護殿デアルナ。
[THE RESPONDENT IS KUROSAKI ICHIGO, I TAKE IT.]
CLERK (katakana officialese, miserable):
其ノ件ハ——異動ガ、ゴザイマス。
[IN THAT MATTER — THERE HAS BEEN A REASSIGNMENT.]

PANEL 4 — The docket, close: the brother's name in its column, and beside it the apparatus of his power, complete in three lines — TRANSFER OF RECORD. INCIDENT REPORT. A PRECEDENT, FILED AND KNOWN. The Counsel's finger rests on the lines like a man touching a railing he has used for years.
CAPTION:
兄ノ力ニハ、書類ガアル。事故ノ届出ガアル。
[The brother's power has papers. It has an incident report.]

PANEL 5 — The clinic at dusk. YUZU sets out two cups from habit, then thinks, and sets out a third — for nobody, for luck. On the wall, the count book rests shut. KARIN takes the MASK down from where it hangs, and looks at it a moment at arm's length, the way a doctor looks at an instrument.
KARIN:
向コウハ、書類ノ女ヲ待ッテル。
[They're waiting for the woman in the papers.]
YUZU:
…行クノ？
[...You're going?]
KARIN:
迎エハ断ラナイ。言ヒ分ハ、向コウデ言フ。
[I don't refuse a summons. I give my answer on their floor.]

PANEL 6 — The hearing room of Episode 5 — the long table, the bell, the rows of chairs — but tonight every chair is FILLED with clerks, silent, tags straight. Lamps burn without flame. At the desk at the room's end, the REGISTRAR, his sleeve drawn carefully over his wrist. In the aisle, the AUDITOR, abacus still. The Counsel waits at the head of the table.
CAPTION:
聽聞室ハ、満席デアル。
[The hearing room is full.]

PANEL 7 — The doors. KARIN enters MASKED — the mask whole, the sheet's mask, worn deliberately and well, the shihakushou's black against the room's grey; MVRRAMASSA sheathed at her side; her stride unhurried. Every clerk's head turns. None of them has ever seen the claimant, only the count of her.
CAPTION:
被申立人、入室。
[The respondent entered.]

PANEL 8 — The Counsel bows to the mask, precisely, as to a document he respects. His opening courtesies are perfect, and perfectly empty.
COUNSEL (katakana officialese):
遠路、御苦勞デアル。…仮面ノ儘デ、結構デアル。
[YOU HAVE COME FAR. ...THE MASK MAY REMAIN AS IT IS.]
KARIN (behind the mask, plain):
あんたもな。
[Same to you.]

PANEL 9 — The Counsel opens the office's case, folio by folio,

on the long table: every stamp in its order, every tag aligned — the stationmaster's double stamp, the hesitation's fossil; the restored name, entered as an irregularity; the unread registrar, entered as a breach. A case with no hole in it. Last, he lays down one sheet alone, apart from the rest: HER form. Two fields. Both blank.
COUNSEL (katakana officialese):
書類ハ、全部揃ッテヰル。——被申立人ノ分ヲ、除イテ。
[THE PAPERS ARE ALL COMPLETE. — EXCEPT THE RESPONDENT'S.]

PANEL 10 — Silence. Karin's masked face turns, slowly, toward the desk at the room's end — toward the REGISTRAR, whose hand, inside his sleeve, FLEXES once. Under the cloth: the ghost of a tremor, the fossil, alive. Karin speaks — not to the Counsel. To the record.
KARIN:
聴聞ハ、始マッタバカリダ。
[The hearing has only just begun.]
CAPTION:
惡魔の舞は、まだ始まらぬ。だが、今夜ハ——違フ。
[The Devil's Dance has not yet begun. But tonight — is different.]

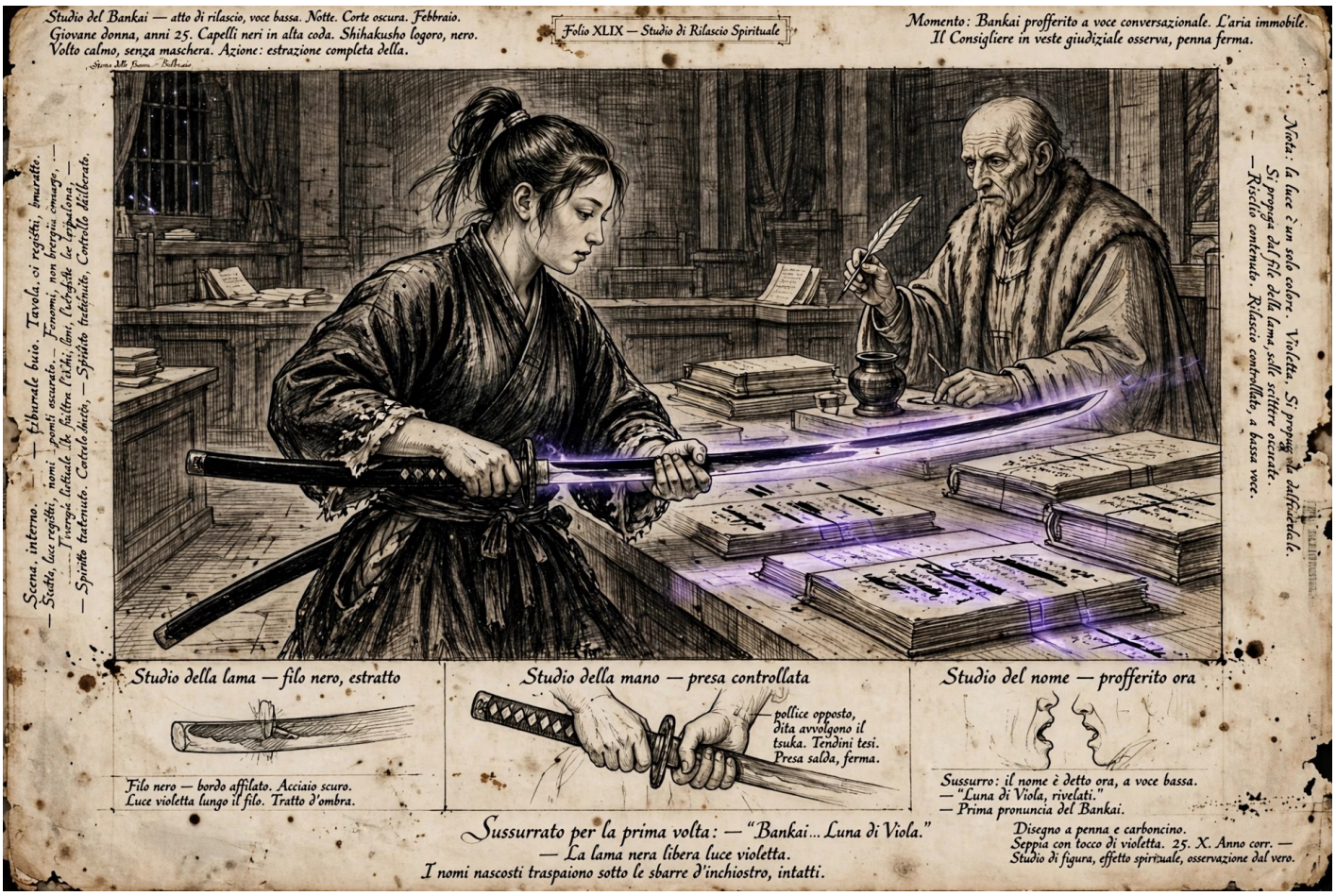
———
Episode 6 ends. The founder's rulings seated in this script: Movement III entered. Counsel comes down EXPECTING THE BROTHER — a transferred power, an incident of record, a case the office knows how to hold — and the office must tell him the claim has moved house: the respondent is the sister, for whom no form exists. Karin attends MASKED, the sheet's mask worn by her own choice, as she promised the Auditor: no filing, but attendance. The office's whole case is paper, and its single hole is her two blank fields. Yuzu's count does not rise in this episode — tonight there is no blackout to count; the governance holds. Desk-set under his pen: the Counsel's name is not spoken in this episode — the office styles him only 代言人, the Counsel; whether he is ever named remains the founder's seam. Her sword: MVRRAMASSA. Her mask: the Leonardo sheet's mask, on her face.

EPISODE 7

THE MOONLESS HEARING

（無月ノ聴聞）

Episode 7 — The Unmasking



Episode 7 — The Naming

Episode 7 — The Dance

THE LITTLEST SISTER, WHEN SHE BLACKS OUT
Manga Arc — Episode 7: THE MOONLESS HEARING （無月ノ聴聞）

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FORMAT: Manga panel script with PARALLEL SUBS — each speech and caption carries the Japanese first (as spoken) and the English directly beneath. The Japanese is set in the FIRST EMPIRE'S DIALECT [desk reading, declared]: imperial-era register — kyuujitai character forms, historical kana, the de-aru voice for narration, katakana officialese for Hell's office, and Karin's own blunt plain speech left plain. MVRRAMASSA and the dance are the founder's; both are spent in this episode, as reserved.

MOVEMENT III — THE MOONLESS HEARING. The hearing itself. A hearing, not a battle: the verdict the office did not know it was capable of, written by its own counsel's hand.

PANELS ILLUSTRATED (Da Vinci pencil-sketch plates):
Panel 4 -> panel-19-the-unmasking.webp
Panel 6 -> panel-20-the-naming.webp
Panel 8 -> panel-21-the-dance.webp

———

PANEL 1 — The hearing room, full dark beyond the lamps. The COUNSEL stands with the office's case complete before him. The summation is short, and it is merciless, and it is fair.
COUNSEL (katakana officialese):
要ハ、一ツデアル。——届ケヲ、出セ。
[THE SUM OF IT IS ONE THING. — FILE.]
COUNSEL (katakana officialese):
サモナクバ、打消シニナル。打消サレタ名ドモノ、仲間入リダ。
[OTHERWISE, YOU WILL BE STRUCK. ONE OF THE STRUCK NAMES.]

PANEL 2 — KARIN, masked, rises. Her answer takes the charges in their order, plain as a clinic ledger, no heat in it.
KARIN:
読ムノハ、盗ムノジャナイ。名ハ、元々其ノ人ノ物ダ。
[Reading isn't stealing. A name belongs to the one who bears it.]
KARIN:
書記ノ事ハ——読マナカッタ。其レガ、罪カ。
[And the registrar — I did NOT read him. Is that the crime?]

PANEL 3 — The Counsel plays the office's last card, gently, as one offers a chair. The brother's file, opened at the incident of record: the transfer, the precedent — a known category, a shelf that already exists.
COUNSEL (katakana officialese):
兄ヲ通セバ、分類ガアル。譲渡ノ前例ガ、當廳ニハアル。
[CLAIM THROUGH THE BROTHER, AND THERE IS A CATEGORY. THE TRANSFER PRECEDENT STANDS IN THIS

OFFICE.]
KARIN:
兄ノ借リ物デハ、ナイ。最初カラ、私ノ物ダ。
[It's not my brother's borrowed thing. It was mine from the start.]

PANEL 4 — Mid-hearing, in the full silence of the office, Karin reaches up with BOTH HANDS and takes the mask off. Not struck off. Not compelled. Hers to lift, hers to set down. She lays it on the clerk's desk at the table's end, gently, the way one lays down an exhibit — the only true paper she has ever owned. Her face: the flat stare, unhurried, entirely hers.
CAPTION:
被申立人、自ラ仮面ヲ外ス。
[The respondent removed her mask herself.]

PANEL 5 — The Counsel looks from the two blank fields on the form at his elbow to the bare face across the table, and for the first time in the record his next line is not in the brief. He asks it quietly, in the office's own tongue, and the clerks write it down before they know they are writing.
COUNSEL (katakana officialese, quietly):
…記録ノ為ニ。名ヲ、伺ヒタイ。
[...FOR THE RECORD. I WOULD HEAR THE NAME.]
KARIN:
黒崎カリン。
[Kurosaki Karin.]
CAPTION:
氏名ハ、申立人ノ言葉ノ儘、記録サレタ。
[The name was entered as the claimant spoke it.]

PANEL 6 — Karin draws. The blade comes out of the sheath the way a name comes out of a mouth: entirely, and once. She speaks the release at conversational volume, to the court.
KARIN:
卍解——ムラマサ・斬月。
[Bankai — MVRRAMASSA ZANGETSV.]
CAPTION:
刀ノ名ハ、最初カラ彼女ノ中ニ在ッタ。譲ラレタ事ハ、一度モナイ。
[The sword's name was inside her from the start. It was never once handed over.]
SFX: シン [shin — a silence with an edge on it]

PANEL 7 — The dance begins. She does not advance on the Counsel. She moves down the long table the way weather moves down a street — measured steps, the black blade describing slow, low arcs above the stacked registers, never touching paper. Where the overwritten names lie under their black bars, a VIOLET FLAME runs along the covered lines: it does not consume, it does not char. It un-covers.
CAPTION:
悪魔ノ舞、無月ノ空ニ——此処デハ、地獄ノ法廷ノ暗ガリデ。
[The Devil's Dance, on a moonless sky — here, in the dark of Hell's own court.]

PANEL 8 — Register after register, the struck names standing legible again in violet light, unburned, restored as she passes: a wife's name, a stationmaster's, names no episode has

carried. At the table's end a CLERK, without being asked, reads the record's own precedent aloud — the first restored name in the whole proceeding.
CLERK (katakana officialese, reading):
前例。——磯部源次郎。一名、復活。一環、適法ニ斷絶。
[PRECEDENT. — ISOBE GENJIROU. ONE NAME, RESTORED. ONE LINK, LAWFULLY BROKEN.]
PANEL CONTINUES — the REGISTRAR, at his desk, draws back his own sleeve with his own hand and looks at his bright chain, and does not hide it again.

PANEL 9 — The verdict. The Counsel closes the brother's file, unused, and takes up HER form — and does not fill it in. He writes ACROSS it, in brush, in his own hand, the office's amendment: the register itself is changed. The file will be written from her testimony: a natural claim, the first of its kind on record; the name as she spoke it; the bloodline as she spoke it.
COUNSEL (katakana officialese, almost gently):
當廳ハ、登録ヲ改メル。本件ハ、天成ノ申立トス。最初ノ、一件トス。
[THIS OFFICE AMENDS ITS REGISTER. THIS MATTER IS A NATURAL CLAIM. THE FIRST OF RECORD.]
CAPTION:
彼女ノ書類ハ、彼女ノ言葉デ書カレタ。初メテ、書類ガ人ニ従ッタノデアル。
[Her file was written in her own words. For the first time, the paper followed the person.]

PANEL 10 — Grey morning, the clinic step. Inside, at the low table, YUZU is asleep over the count book, cheek on her folded arms; the count stands at TEN, and under it, in her own small hand, one character more: 終 — closed. Karin sets the clinic coat over her sister's shoulders and looks once at the street, empty, ordinary, moonless no longer an issue because it is morning.
CAPTION:
惡魔の舞は、踊ラレタノデアル。戰ヒトシテデハナク、聽聞トシテ。
[The Devil's Dance has been danced. Not as a battle. As a hearing.]
KARIN:
…朝ダ。店、開ケルゾ。
[...Morning. Open the clinic.]

———
Episode 7 ends — and with it the arc's main line: MOVEMENT III complete. The founder's rulings seated in this script: the hearing is a hearing, not a battle; she unmasks BY HER OWN CHOICE, mid-hearing, and the mask is laid down as an exhibit, not torn away; the Bankai is spent — MVRRAMASSA ZANGETSV, named on the page, the release hers by inheritance and never by transfer, the transfer precedent REFUSED as her category; the dance is the feminine AKVMA NO MAI MVGETSV, danced as PRECEDENT in the courtroom's dark, the violet flame that does not burn but heals, the written-over names restored as she passes; the record itself cites the Isobe precedent (Episode 3). The verdict: the office amends its own register — her file written from her testimony, the first natural claim on record; name and bloodline entered AS SHE SPOKE THEM — Kurosaki Karin, the KUROSAKI bloodline. Episode 1's closing line is answered: the dance has been danced — as a hearing. Yuzu's count closes

at ten, the figure desk-set in Episode 4 under his pen; the closing character 終 is hers within the fiction and the desk's on the page. Her sword: MVRRAMASSA. Her mask: the Leonardo sheet's mask — set down, whole, by her own hands.

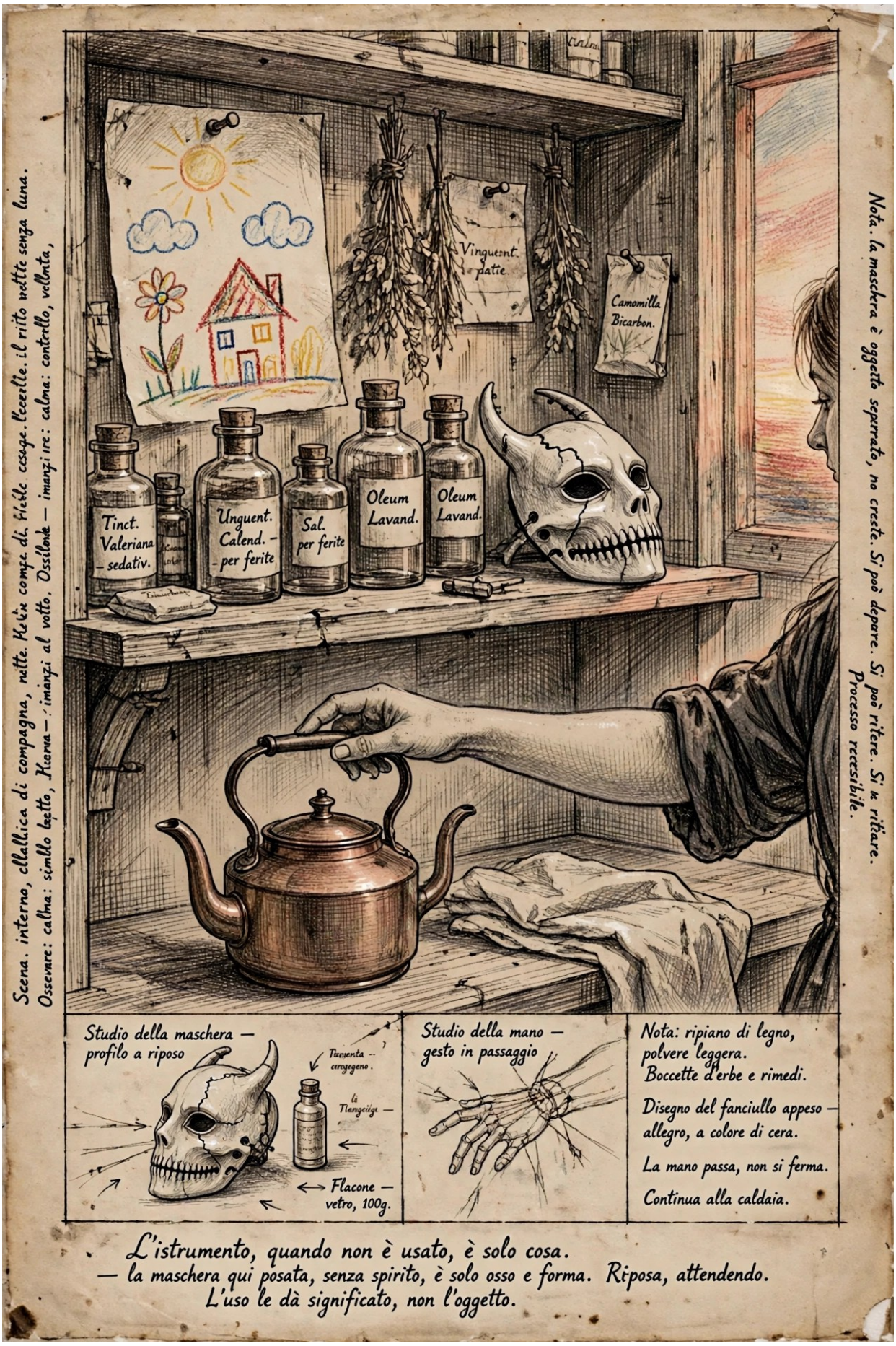
EPISODE 8 (EPILOGUE)

THE COUNT COMES HOME

（數ノ歸リ）

Episode 8 — The Mail

Episode 8 — The Count Book



Episode 8 — The Shelf

THE LITTLEST SISTER, WHEN SHE BLACKS OUT
Manga Arc — Episode 8 (EPILOGUE): THE COUNT COMES HOME （數ノ歸リ）

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MOVEMENT III — CODA. The hearing is over. What remains is the paperwork of peace, which arrives by ordinary post.

PANELS ILLUSTRATED (Da Vinci pencil-sketch plates):
Panel 2 -> panel-22-the-mail.webp
Panel 4 -> panel-23-the-count-book.webp
Panel 6 -> panel-24-the-shelf.webp

———

PANEL 1 — The clinic, a morning some days on. Ordinary light. A short queue of the LIVING at the door — a sprained wrist, a feverish grandfather, a schoolgirl holding her stomach and her courage. KARIN works the room with a thermometer and no wasted motion. The war is twelve years gone. The weather is only weather.
CAPTION:
診療所ハ、通常営業デアル。
[The clinic is open as usual.]

PANEL 2 — The postman at the step, unhurried, thinking nothing of it. Among the bills and a seed catalogue, ONE heavy envelope, office-black, formal as a funeral — and on it, a stamp placed, for the first time in the whole record, EXACTLY where a stamp belongs: aligned to the hair.
POSTMAN:
重いですね。請求書？
[Heavy, isn't it. A bill?]
KARIN:
…違う。向コウノ、返事だ。
[...No. It's their answer.]

PANEL 3 — The envelope opened at the low table. Inside, a copy of the new register page: HER file, written from her testimony, her name as she spoke it. And beneath it a second sheet — the office's own new form, printed since the verdict, with a field

no form of theirs has ever carried:
申立人ノ言葉ノ儘 — "IN THE CLAIMANT'S OWN WORDS."
YUZU reads over her sister's shoulder, and laughs once, out loud, in the quiet room.
YUZU:
…カリン、勝ッチャッタ。
[...Karin. You won.]
KARIN:
勝負ジャ、ナイ。聴聞ダ。
[It wasn't a contest. It was a hearing.]

PANEL 4 — Evening. YUZU at the kitchen table with the count book — the tallies of the blackouts, the room's light taken and returned, page on page in her careful hand. The last entry stands where the hearing left it: TEN, and beneath it, closed. She ties the book with string, twice around, and puts it in the drawer — not hidden. Filed. The good kind of filing.
CAPTION:
數ハ、仕舞ハレタ。隠サレタノデハナク、片付イタノデアル。
[The count was put away. Not hidden — settled.]

PANEL 5 — Far away, the intake office, lamplight. The REGISTRAR alone at his desk, his sleeve rolled back and left back. Before him: a blank form — the new one, with the new field. Slowly, in his own hand, in the field that asks for the claimant's own words, the man who stamped a thousand names begins to write his own.
CAPTION:
書記ハ、初メテ、自分ノ名ヲ書キ始メタ。
[The registrar began, for the first time, to write his own name.]

PANEL 6 — The clinic shelf, evening. Between the medicine bottles and a child's crayon drawing left behind by a small patient: THE MASK. Whole. Clean. At rest. It is not sealed, not boxed, not hidden — it sits the way a stethoscope sits: an instrument of the house. Karin's hand passes it without stopping, on her way to the kettle.
CAPTION:
仮面ハ、棚ノ上デ休ンデヰル。道具ハ、使ハレヌ時、唯ノ物デアル。
[The mask rests on the shelf. A tool, when it is not in use, is only a thing.]

PANEL 7 — Night. The clinic window from the street: lamplight, two sisters at the low table, tea going cold in the ordinary way. Above the town the sky is what it has been all along — cloud-choked, starless, MOONLESS — and for the first time in the record it reads as nothing but weather.
CAPTION:
鎖ハ、モウ數エナイ。數ハ、家ニ歸ッタノデアル。
[The chains are no longer counted. The count has come home.]

———
Episode 8 ends — the epilogue, and the arc entire. The founder's rulings seated in this script: the peace is administrative — Hell's amended register arrives by ordinary post, the office's new form carrying a field it never had (the claimant's own

words; the field's wording is desk-set under his pen); the count closes at home, Yuzu filing her own book the good way; the registrar takes up the precedent for himself, in his own hand; the mask rests on the shelf as an object — the sheet's mask, whole, neither sealed nor worshipped. No new claim is opened; no dance remains owed. Movement I: the Intake. Movement II: the Hearings That Never Happened. Movement III: the Moonless Hearing — heard, answered, and come home. Her sword: MVRRAMASSA. Her mask: the Leonardo sheet's mask, on the shelf. Her name: Kurosaki Karin, as she speaks it.

COLOPHON

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93 — Live, Love, and let Love, Live.